

* Principle

Chromatography is based on the principle of differential partitioning, where the component of a mixture are separated based on their interaction with a stationary phase & mobile phase.

* Types of chromatography

1. Paper chromatography: Uses paper as the stationary phase and a solvent as the mobile phase.
2. Thin layer chromatography (TLC): Uses a thin layer of silica gel or alumina as the stationary phase & solvent as the mobile phase.
3. Column chromatography: Uses a column packed with a stationary phase & a solvent as the mobile phase.
4. Gas chromatography (GC): Uses a gas as the mobile phase & a stationary phase coated on a column.
5. Liquid chromatography (LC): Uses a liquid as the mobile phase & a stationary phase coated on a column.

Applications

Chromatography has a wide range of applications in various fields, including:

1. Pharmaceutical: To separate & identify active ingredients & impurities.
2. Forensic: Used to analyze evidence & identify substances.
3. Environmental: Monitoring & detecting & measuring pollutants in air, water & soil.
4. Food & Beverages: To analyze the composition of food & beverages.
5. Biotechnology: To separate & purify biomolecules, such as proteins & nucleic acids.

Advantages

1. High Sensitivity & Selectivity: Chromatography can detect & separate very small amounts of substances.
2. Fast Analysis: Chromatography can analyze complex mixtures quickly & efficiently.
3. High Accuracy: Chromatography can provide accurate and reliable results.